

Creating a bootable CD on Nero 6

For creating a bootable disk, we will use Nero 6 Express, which is the easiest way to do it. Start the application, and from the Nero Express menu, select the 'Bootable data disc' option under the Data menu. This takes you to another



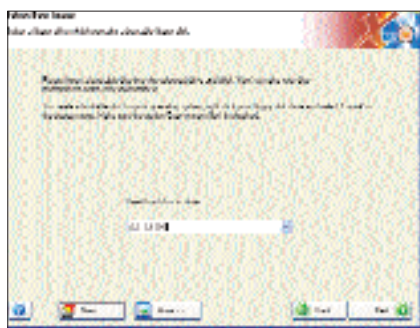
Creating a boot-able floppy in Windows XP

window, which asks for any files that you want to add onto the bootable CD. If you don't want to add any files, skip this by clicking Next.

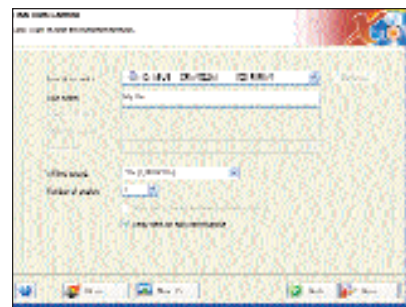
At the next window,

you need to have a bootable floppy disk. To create one in Windows XP, click My Computer and right-click the floppy drive icon. Then select Format from the menu, and select 'Create an MS-DOS startup disk'. Click Start in Windows 98, go to 'Add / Remove Programs' in the Control Panel and select the 'Startup Disk' tab.

Insert a blank floppy disk into the drive and click Create Disk.



Insert floppy containing the bootable image



The final step

Now that you have a floppy disk ready, insert the floppy containing the bootable image into your floppy drive. Select the recorder, give a name for the CD, enter the number of copies you want and click Burn.

The bootable disc will be created in a few minutes, depending on the writing speed of your CD-writer, and the medium used.

find the perfect combination for filling a CD completely. If it can't all fit on one CD, the software shows you how many CDs are required, and shows the files it will include in a tree structure. You then create ISO images from these files, and burn them onto your CD. This takes a lot of time, however, when the size of your backup increases, and requires more than two CDs to write it on.

Clone CD 4.2.02: Use this utility to create perfect backups of your CD collection. There's a wizard-like interface which is easy to use, even for first-time users. You can save images of your CDs on hard disk, and also write CDs from image

MPV Vs. HighMAT

MPV and HighMAT are two new CD formats that have recently entered the market. The USP of these formats is that any device supporting them will allow easy sharing and management of image, music and movie files. MPV is developed by the Optical Storage Technology Association (OSTA). The list of vendors supporting OSTA is huge, but currently no one has released a drive that supports the format.

HighMAT is a proprietary specification developed jointly by Microsoft and Matsushita. Many of HighMAT's features overlap with those in MPV, but MPV enjoys support on many more platforms.



files—this means you can make a copy of a CD using just one CD-RW drive. Another nice feature is its logging ability: it creates a complete log of all the activities that take place during the CD-copy process so that you can check the log files if something goes wrong.

Exact Audio Copy: This one is tailor-made for audiophiles—it's the perfect audio grabber, comes for free and has a friendly interface. Exact Audio Copy supports useful features such as jitter correction, automatic speed reduction on errors, normalization of extracted audio and many more. It has a CD-writing tool that can automatically detect drive features, and work according to that. It also helps you convert WAV files to the MP3 format by installing the LAME MP3 encoder on your system.

CD Catalog Expert 8.0: If you have a gigantic music and video collection on hundreds of CDs, this indispensable tool can organise and maintain a catalogue of it. You can create your own categories and shuffle files around by category. It has a search facility to search through catalogues using file name, folder name, catalogue name and even catalogue comment. Another good feature is report creation—you can generate reports in HTML based on catalogue and category.

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